

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 40)

Page 197 - Keats and Shelley

Q1. In Shelley's 'Prometheus Unbound', what does the Titan symbolize?

- A. The prototype of mankind in its long struggle against despotism
- B. The beauty of the Greek past
- C. The exhaustion of revolutionary impulses
- D. The forces of nature

Answer: A

Q2. Who represents the forces of despotism in 'Prometheus Unbound'?

- A. Prometheus
- B. Jupiter
- C. Endymion
- D. Apollo

Answer: B

Q3. John Keats was the last and youngest of which group?

- A. The early Augustan poets
- B. The later revolutionary group
- C. The pre-Raphaelite brotherhood
- D. The Cavalier poets

Answer: B

Q4. Unlike Byron and Shelley, what was Keats's attitude towards his time?

- A. He was a stormy rebel
- B. He was a humanitarian reformer
- C. He had an almost complete detachment
- D. He was deeply involved in politics

Answer: C

Q5. How did Keats conceive of poetry?

- A. As the vehicle of philosophy
- B. As religious teaching
- C. As the incarnation of beauty
- D. As a tool for social reform

Answer: C

Q6. Which poem opens with 'A thing of beauty is a joy for ever'?

- A. Lamia
- B. Hyperion
- C. Endymion
- D. The Eve of St. Agnes

Answer: C

Q7. Instead of looking to the future land of promise like Shelley, where did Keats seek imaginative escape?

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- A. The past of Greek mythology and medieval romance
- B. The industrial cities of England
- C. The philosophical texts of Germany
- D. The scientific discoveries of his age

Answer: A

Q8. Which of the following is a fragmentary poem by Keats?

- A. Endymion
- B. Hyperion
- C. Lamia
- D. Isabella

Answer: B

Q9. How did Keats's treatment of nature differ from Wordsworth's and Shelley's?

- A. It was full of spiritual messages and meanings
- B. It was purely scientific and analytical
- C. There was nothing mystical in it; he loved it for its sensuous beauty
- D. He disliked nature and preferred urban settings

Answer: C

Q10. At what age did John Keats die of consumption?

- A. Before he completed his twenty-sixth year
- B. Thirty-six
- C. Forty-five
- D. Fifty-two

Answer: A

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Page 198 - Keats and Minor Poets

Q1. What phrase did Shelley use to describe Keats due to his early death?

- A. A stormy rebel
- B. One of the inheritors of unfulfilled renown
- C. The incarnation of beauty
- D. A willing martyr

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following odes is NOT mentioned as being in Keats's volume of 1819?

- A. To Autumn
- B. To a Nightingale
- C. On a Grecian Urn
- D. To Melancholy

Answer: D

Q3. On the side of form and style, how is Keats described?

- A. The most classical of the romantic poets
- B. The most romantic of the romantic poets
- C. The most realistic of his generation
- D. A strict follower of Hellenic temperance

Answer: B

Q4. Which poetic form did Keats reject, following the lead of Leigh Hunt?

- A. Blank verse
- B. Spenserian stanza
- C. The classic couplet
- D. The sonnet

Answer: C

Q5. Historically, Keats represents the exhaustion of impulses generated by what event?

- A. The Industrial Revolution
- B. The Renaissance
- C. The social upheaval of the Revolution
- D. The Restoration

Answer: C

Q6. Who wrote the 'Story of Rimini' (1816)?

- A. James Henry Leigh Hunt
- B. Thomas Hood
- C. John Hamilton Reynolds
- D. Winthrop Mackworth Praed

Answer: A

Q7. What innovation did Leigh Hunt introduce in the 'Story of Rimini'?

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- A. The rejection of the classic couplet in favor of a freer form
- B. The invention of the dramatic monologue
- C. The first use of free verse
- D. The revival of the epic poem

Answer: A

Q8. In which early poem of Keats was freedom carried to a degree of licence that Hunt disapproved?

- A. Hyperion
- B. Lamia
- C. Endymion
- D. The Eve of St. Agnes

Answer: C

Q9. Which poet married a sister of Keats's intimate friend, John Hamilton Reynolds?

- A. James Henry Leigh Hunt
- B. Thomas or Tom Hood
- C. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- D. Lord Byron

Answer: B

Q10. How is Thomas Hood's life described?

- A. A life of aristocratic luxury
- B. One protracted struggle against poverty and ill-health
- C. A peaceful life in the countryside
- D. A life full of political activism

Answer: B

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Page 199 - Thomas Hood and Minor Poets

Q1. Thomas Hood is perhaps chiefly remembered for what kind of poems?

- A. Epic narratives
- B. Humorous poems, mastering verbal wit and punning
- C. Political satires
- D. Philosophical epics

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is a ballad or lyric by Thomas Hood?

- A. The Song of the Shirt
- B. Ingoldsby Legends
- C. The Bride's Tragedy
- D. Story of Rimini

Answer: A

Q3. Which poem by Hood is described as a masterpiece in the gruesome grotesque?

- A. The Bridge of Sighs
- B. Miss Kilmansegg
- C. Fair Inez
- D. The Haunted House

Answer: B

Q4. Who is the author of 'Ingoldsby Legends'?

- A. Winthrop Mackworth Praed
- B. Richard Harris Barham
- C. Thomas Lovell Beddoes
- D. John Clare

Answer: B

Q5. 'Ingoldsby Legends' is a burlesque development of what trend made popular by Scott?

- A. Classicism
- B. Realism
- C. Mediaevalism
- D. Hellenism

Answer: C

Q6. Who wrote 'The Bride's Tragedy' and 'Death's Jest-Book'?

- A. Thomas Lovell Beddoes
- B. Winthrop Mackworth Praed
- C. Letitia Elizabeth Landon
- D. Felicia Dorothea Hemans

Answer: A

Q7. Beddoes' work represents a strange revival of what spirit?

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- A. The romantic optimism of the 19th century
- B. The morbid and fantastic spirit of the later Elizabethan drama
- C. The strict rules of Augustan poetry
- D. The simplicity of early ballads

Answer: B

Q8. Letitia Elizabeth Landon was commonly known by what initials?

- A. L.E.D.
- B. L.E.L.
- C. L.E.M.
- D. L.E.S.

Answer: B

Q9. John Clare was known as the last of which type of poets?

- A. The aristocratic poets
- B. The peasant poets
- C. The Cavalier poets
- D. The metaphysical poets

Answer: B

Q10. Where was John Clare confined when he wrote much of his best verse?

- A. The mad-house at Northampton
- B. The Tower of London
- C. A monastery in France
- D. A hospital in London

Answer: A

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Page 200 - John Clare

Q1. Who edited 'Selected Poems' by John Clare?

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Grigson
- C. Leigh Hunt
- D. Thomas Hood

Answer: B

Q2. In what year was Grigson's edition of 'Selected Poems' published?

- A. 1821
- B. 1950
- C. 1949
- D. 1850

Answer: B

Q3. What is the title of the 1949 collection edited by Grigson?

- A. The Peasant Poet
- B. Poems of Clare's Madness
- C. Rural Life in England
- D. The Madhouse Poems

Answer: B

Q4. John Clare's works represented in the 1950 volume were written during:

- A. His travels in Italy
- B. His lifetime
- C. The Augustan age
- D. The late 18th century

Answer: B

Q5. Which editor is credited with collecting both 'Selected Poems' and 'Poems of Clare's Madness'?

- A. Lockhart
- B. Grigson
- C. Jeffrey
- D. Brougham

Answer: B

Q6. 'Poems of Clare's Madness' was published in which year?

- A. 1949
- B. 1950
- C. 1899
- D. 1832

Answer: A

Q7. John Clare's poetry in these collections is notable for:

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- A. Being mostly prose
- B. Reflecting his life experiences including his time of madness
- C. Discussing urban industrialization
- D. Focusing on classical Greek myths

Answer: B

Q8. The publication of 'Poems of Clare's Madness' highlights what aspect of Clare's life?

- A. His political career
- B. His academic achievements
- C. His period of insanity
- D. His wealth

Answer: C

Q9. In these two collections, Grigson brings attention to the work of which poet?

- A. John Keats
- B. Thomas Hood
- C. John Clare
- D. Lord Byron

Answer: C

Q10. What is the correct sequence of publication for the two Grigson collections mentioned?

- A. Selected Poems in 1949, Poems of Clare's Madness in 1950
- B. Poems of Clare's Madness in 1949, Selected Poems in 1950
- C. Both were published in 1950
- D. Both were published in 1949

Answer: B

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Page 201 - The Age of Wordsworth: General Prose

Q1. What was an important feature in the history of prose literature during the Age of Wordsworth?

- A. The decline of the novel
- B. The rise of the modern review and magazine
- C. The disappearance of drama
- D. The start of serialized poetry

Answer: B

Q2. When was the Edinburgh Review established?

- A. 1802
- B. 1817
- C. 1824
- D. 1830

Answer: A

Q3. The Edinburgh Review was established by men of letters associated with which political party?

- A. The Tory party
- B. The Whig party
- C. The Labour party
- D. The Liberal party

Answer: B

Q4. Which of the following was NOT a founder of the Edinburgh Review?

- A. Jeffrey
- B. Brougham
- C. Sydney Smith
- D. William Gifford

Answer: D

Q5. Which publication was started as a Tory counterblast to the Edinburgh Review?

- A. The London Magazine
- B. Fraser's
- C. The Quarterly
- D. Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine

Answer: C

Q6. Who was the first editor of the Quarterly?

- A. William Gifford
- B. Lockhart
- C. Wilson
- D. Hogg

Answer: A

Q7. Who succeeded William Gifford as the editor of the Quarterly in 1824?

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- A. Brougham
- B. Scott's son-in-law, Lockhart
- C. Charles Lamb
- D. William Hazlitt

Answer: B

Q8. Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine was launched in what year?

- A. 1809
- B. 1802
- C. 1817
- D. 1830

Answer: C

Q9. Which magazine included Lamb, Hazlitt, and De Quincey among its early contributors?

- A. The London Magazine
- B. The Edinburgh Review
- C. Fraser's
- D. The Quarterly

Answer: A

Q10. Fraser's, a well-known periodical of the general magazine type, was founded in which year?

- A. 1817
- B. 1824
- C. 1830
- D. 1809

Answer: C